

Tennessee Secretary of State
Tre Hargett



Elections Division
312 Rosa L. Parks Avenue, 7th Floor
Nashville, Tennessee 37243-1102

Mark Goins
Coordinator of Elections

615-741-7956
Mark.Goins@tnsos.gov

MEMORANDUM

To: All County Election Commissions

From: Mark Goins *Mark Goins*
Coordinator of Elections

Date: May 7, 2026

Subject: Implementation of Revised Congressional Districts

CC: The Honorable Tre Hargett, Tennessee Secretary of State

The special session has concluded, and the Governor has signed legislation revising congressional district boundaries and related election processes. Please review the following information carefully and let us know if you have questions.

Notices

The law requires our office to provide notice of the revised districts and special qualifying process described later in this memo on our website. This information is now available at <https://sos.tn.gov/announcements/2026-congressional-redistricting>.

If you are in a county in which all or any portion of a redrawn congressional district is located, you must also publish notice on the county election commission's official website, if one exists. The most efficient way to do this is by linking to our website. Please make sure the link is prominent on your homepage. Even if a district did not change in your county, you should post the link in case voters in your district are looking for that information.

There has been significant news coverage regarding the new districts. Therefore, many of your voters will be aware of the changes. Under the legislation, you are not required to publish the new districts or notice of offices to be elected and deadlines in a newspaper of general circulation.

Candidate qualifying

The legislation contains provisions for both existing candidates and for additional candidates. Existing candidates who qualified by the March 10 qualifying deadline are not required to file new petitions. These candidates will have three options:

1. Run in the district that has the same district number as previously qualified.
2. Run in a new district that has a different district number than what appeared on the petition by filing a notarized statement with the coordinator of elections by noon on May 15.
3. Withdraw by noon on May 15 by filing a notarized statement with the coordinator of elections.

Our office will notify the candidates of these options. Candidates may file notarized statements to change districts or withdraw in person, by mail, or by attaching the statement to an email. Existing candidates who take no action will remain qualified in the district listed on their original nominating petition.

The qualifying deadline is open in **all** nine congressional districts. New candidates must file during a special qualifying period that begins now and lasts until noon on Friday, May 15. Candidates can pick up petitions from our office or your office.

Please be prepared to issue petitions to congressional candidates. Because of the compressed qualifying period, we expect they are more likely to pick up from your office even though they file with us. When issuing congressional petitions, please remember:

- The blank at the top of the petition for county should be filled in as "N/A" since congressional districts are multi-county districts.
- Please make sure the correct district, party, and election date are listed on any petition issued. The election date for independent candidates is November 3.
- If you print the qualifying deadline on the petition, make sure it says noon on May 15.
- No candidates can withdraw after the qualifying deadline. If you print the withdrawal deadline on the petition, make sure it says noon on May 15.
- You should provide the summary outline to candidates, so they have all the information about when and where to file.

There are a couple of important updates to the petition process to be aware of. First, new candidates can collect signatures from any voter registered in a county that is wholly or partially within the new district. This provision will only apply to this election to assist in the transition to new districts. Please keep this in mind as you review signatures on any petition filed during the special qualifying period.

Second, candidates must file the original with the coordinator of elections. For candidates wanting to run in a primary, they still must file a certified duplicate with the party by the deadline.

The parties retain their ability to remove candidates who do not meet bona fide requirements under their rules. Any determination that a new candidate should be removed from the ballot must be filed

with the coordinator of elections by email by noon on May 17. Candidates who are disqualified by a party cannot appeal the party's decision.

We will certify the list of candidates to you as soon as practicable after the parties' deadline. Your county election commission must approve the ballot in a public meeting. If held at a time other than their regularly scheduled meeting, you will have to provide public notice. Costs incurred as a result of extra meetings required by these revisions are reimbursable. Remember that the agenda for your meetings must be posted for at least 48 hours before the meeting.

Reassignment of voters

To determine what updates will need to be made to your voter registration records, you will need to review the maps, information from the Comptroller's office, and the legislation to determine which district(s) your county now contains. Counties will fall into one of the following categories:

- For counties with no changes to district boundaries or numbering, no voter reassignment will be required.
- For counties that are entirely in one congressional district under the new boundaries, some have a new district number. In these counties, all voters will need to be reassigned to the new district number. Your voter registration vendor should be able to assist you in running a batch update to handle this quickly.
- For counties that now include multiple congressional districts and counties where splits have been revised, you will need to make sure voters are assigned to the correct district. Matthew Hill in the Comptroller's office has offered his assistance. If you have local GIS staff, they will be a resource as well. The process you follow to import maps or update your street index will depend on your voter registration system vendor. After assignments are made by your office, Matthew Hill will perform a comparison to ensure correct assignments.

If the boundaries have changed in your county, you will need to review the new district boundaries in relation to your existing precinct boundaries. A precinct is allowed to contain more than one congressional district. However, some counties may wish to adjust precinct boundaries in order to minimize precinct splits. If precinct boundaries are adjusted and voters are assigned to a new polling place, you must mail notice of the new polling place to every active voter affected.

Additionally, some counties may wish to mail notice to voters to inform them of their updated district number. While you are not required to mail notice solely based on a district number change, the legislature anticipated that some counties may wish to do so and provided funds sufficient to reimburse for these mailings.

Update election management system

You will also need to make updates to your voting systems to ensure the correct districts and candidates appear on the ballot. The existing election templates in your election management system are based on the district boundaries adopted in 2022. These templates will need to be updated or rebuilt to ensure the correct splits are assigned. You must proof and test the updates to ensure their accuracy.

Reimbursements

The new law provided plenty of financial resources to reimburse counties for expenses incurred by the county election commission in implementing the new districts. Eligible expenses include, but are not limited to:

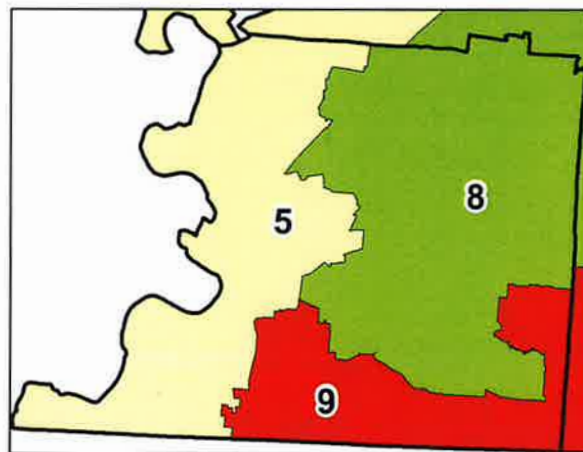
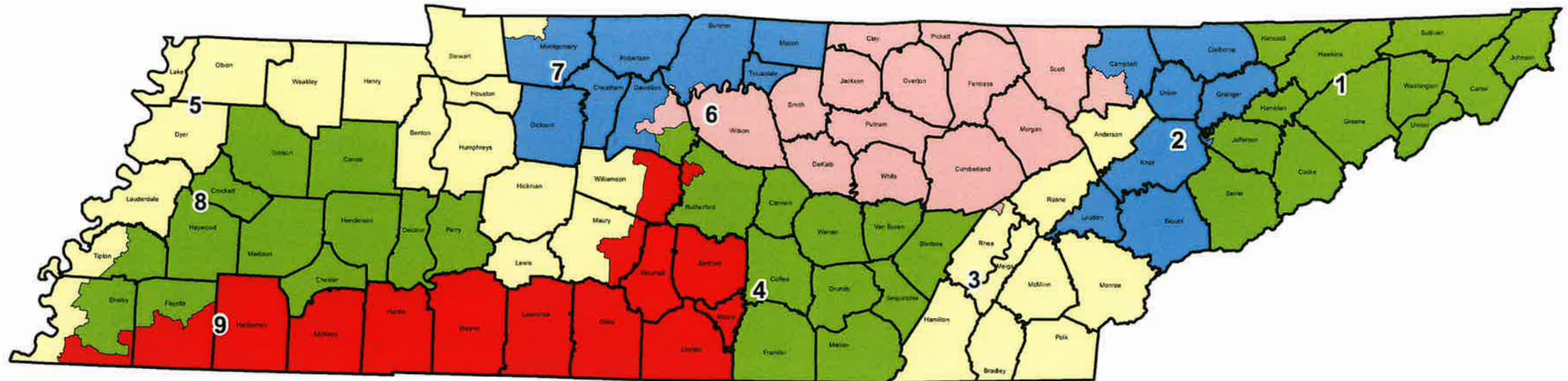
- Ample staffing costs to implement changes, including overtime or temporary workers
- Fees charged by vendors
- Mailing notices regarding new districts or polling place changes
- County election commission meetings to review revisions and ballots

Please keep up with any expenses related to these revisions. We will provide more detailed instructions about how to submit, but the process will be similar to submitting your expenses for primaries that are reimbursed.

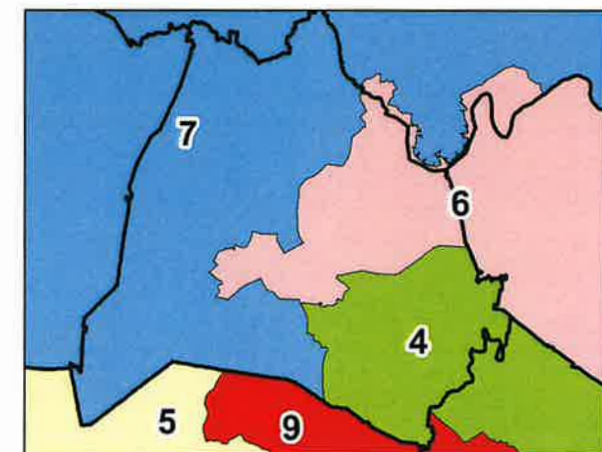
TENNESSEE

U.S. Congress

Districts Adopted May 7, 2026



Shelby County



Davidson County